Part A: Surface Perception (Above Water)
Analyze the trade-offs (Cost vs. Performance vs. Environmental Robustness) for:

1. **Optical Cameras:** Global Shutter vs. Rolling Shutter. Necessity of polarization filters for water glare.
2. **LiDAR:** Performance of solid-state vs. mechanical LiDARs on water (absorption/reflection issues).
3. **Radar:** Efficacy of compact mmWave radars for detecting non-metallic obstacles (logs) in fog.

Part B: Underwater Perception (Subsurface)
Compare methods for bathymetry and underwater obstacle avoidance in **turbid/muddy river water**:
4. **Acoustic Sensors (Sonar):** Single-beam echosounders (Altimeters) vs. Forward-Looking Sonar (FLS) vs. Side-Scan Sonar. Which is essential for safety?
5. **Optical Underwater Cameras:** Are they viable in river environments? Discuss limitations regarding turbidity and light attenuation.

Part C: Navigation & State Estimation (Localization)
Analyze budget-friendly COTS (Commercial Off-The-Shelf) components for state estimation:
6. **GNSS/GPS:** Standard L1 modules (e.g., u-blox NEO) vs. Dual-band L1/L5 RTK systems. Accuracy requirements for river navigation.
7. **IMU (Inertial Measurement Unit):** The role of Accelerometers and Gyroscopes in pitch/roll compensation for cameras.
8. **Magnetometers (Compass):** Issues with magnetic interference on boats and calibration hard/soft iron effects.

Part D: Recommendations
Suggest a "Research-Grade" budget sensor suite (Bill of Materials) suitable for a university project, specifying:

- Recommended sensor models (e.g., BlueRobotics, Reach, WitMotion, Oak-D, Realsense).
- Optimal mounting positions to minimize interference.

Now I'll create the comprehensive final report for the user.

Comprehensive Technical Survey: Sensor Stack for Autonomous USV in River Environments

This report synthesizes trade-offs across surface, underwater, navigation, and state estimation sensors for autonomous river USVs operating in turbid, complex environments.

PART A: SURFACE PERCEPTION (ABOVE WATER)

1. Optical Cameras: Global Shutter vs. Rolling Shutter & Polarization Filters

Global Shutter Fundamentals:

Global shutter cameras expose all pixels **simultaneously**, eliminating row-by-row timing that causes geometric distortion in fast-moving scenes. This is critical for USV obstacle detection because:

- **Motion fidelity**: Water-obstacle boundary detection requires undistorted horizon lines; rolling shutter produces curved horizons during yaw maneuvers[1][2]
- **Fast obstacle detection**: Buoys, logs, vessels moving at 1-3 m/s appear geometrically skewed with rolling shutter
- **Flash synchronization**: Global shutter maintains 100% duty cycle with pulsed light sources (important for polarization filters used with controlled illumination)

Trade-offs Table:

Characteristic	Global Shutter	Rolling Shutter
Motion distortion	None (simultaneous exposure)	Skewing/jello effect at >0.5 m/s
Frame rate	Lower (15-30 fps typical)	Higher (60-120 fps)
Native sensitivity	Lower by 10-20% (larger pixels)	Higher (smaller pixels)
Dynamic range	60-70 dB	70-80 dB
Cost	2-3× more expensive	Budget baseline
Environmental robustness	Better (LED banding immunity)	Susceptible to pulsed lighting

Recommendation for river USV: **Global shutter mandatory** for autonomous collision avoidance. Rolling shutter acceptable only for low-speed monitoring (<0.5 m/s) with human oversight.[2-1][3][1-1]

Polarization Filters: Physics & Performance

Water reflects sunlight in a **specularly polarized state** perpendicular to the surface. A circular polarization filter (CPL) blocks these linearly polarized reflections while transmitting depolarized light from submerged features:

$$I_{\text{transmitted}} = I_0 \cos^2(\theta) \text{ where } \theta = \text{angle between filter and reflection polarization}$$

Effectiveness by environment:

- Optimal (25° off-nadir incidence): 70-90% glare reduction
- Clear water (Secchi depth >2 m): Enables 2-4 m visibility vs. 0.5-1 m without filter
- Turbid water (>20 NTU suspended sediment): Polarization filters reduce glare but cannot overcome **volumetric scattering** (effectiveness drops to 10-20%)

Recommendation: **CPL filters essential** for above-water cameras in river environments. Cost: $30-80 per filter. Install on optical turret for maintenance access.[4]

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2. LiDAR: Solid-State vs. Mechanical on Water

Mechanical LiDAR Challenges on Water:

Mechanical scanning LiDARs (64-128 channels, 100-200 m range) face critical water-specific physics:

Specular Reflection Problem:
When laser beams hit calm water orthogonally (perpendicular incidence), ~95% of energy reflects back as specular reflection, causing receiver saturation and loss of subsurface returns. Solution: **conical scanning pattern at 15-20° off-nadir angle**, which:

- Eliminates specular saturation
- Reduces point cloud density by ~20% (fewer channels directly ahead)
- Increases horizontal scan gaps[5][6]

Absorption & Scattering in Turbid Rivers:

Infrared wavelengths (800-1550 nm used in standard LiDAR) exhibit exponential attenuation: $I(z) = I_0 e^{-kz}$

Turbidity coefficient k in river environments: 0.1-0.5 m^{-1} (clear) to 0.5-3.0 m^{-1} (muddy)

Resulting penetration depths:

- Clear water + IR LiDAR: 0.5-1 m subsurface detection
- Turbid river (>50 NTU) + IR LiDAR: <0.3 m (surface-only detection)

- Green wavelength bathymetric LiDAR (532 nm, specialized): 5-25 m penetration (but not standard COTS)[6-1][5-1]

Solid-State LiDAR Advantages for Rivers:

Aspect	Mechanical	Solid-State
Range above water	120-200 m	50-100 m
Subsurface penetration	3-5 m (clear water)	0.5-2 m (marginal)
Reliability	Higher maintenance (moving parts)	Lower (MEMS, no moving parts)
Water tolerance	Specular issues, vibration-sensitive	MEMS resilient, compact waterproofing
Cost	$8k-15k	$3k-8k
Power consumption	10-20 W	2-5 W
Integration complexity	High (calibration, software)	Low (plug-and-play)
River-specific rating	**Mediocre (specular/turbidity)**	**Better (compact, sealed)**

Recommendation for river USV: **Solid-state LiDAR (32-channel equivalent or Livox Mid-360) preferable** for obstacle detection above water. Combine with polarization-filtered camera for visual confirmation. Mechanical LiDAR only justified if **bathymetry/underwater mapping** is primary mission objective.[5-2]

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3. mmWave Radar: Non-Metallic Obstacle Detection & Fog Performance

mmWave Radar Cross-Section (RCS) by Material:

mmWave (77-90 GHz) detection strength depends critically on electrical conductivity and size relative to wavelength:

Obstacle Type	Material	RCS @ 77 GHz	Detection Range
Metal buoy	Steel	+10 to +15 dBsm	>200 m

Obstacle Type	Material	RCS @ 77 GHz	Detection Range
Wooden log	Wood (dry/wet)	-10 to -5 dBsm	30-50 m
Plastic buoy	PVC/polyethylene	-15 to -10 dBsm	10-30 m
Foam debris	Foam/organic matter	-20 to -15 dBsm	<20 m
Human body	Water-tissue mix	-5 to 0 dBsm	20-40 m
Water surface	Liquid (specular)	-40 dBsm + clutter	False alarms

Key insight: mmWave **excels at metallic obstacles** (buoys, ships) but **struggles with non-metallic logs and debris** typical of river hazards. A wooden log 30 cm diameter has RCS ~-10 dBsm, requiring 30-50 m range for safe reaction time (unacceptable for fast-moving obstacle). [7][8][9]

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mmWave Performance in Adverse Weather:

Advantages:

- **Fog/rain penetration**: 77 GHz microwaves pass through precipitation without scattering (unlike visible light, which scatters off raindrops)
- **Doppler velocity measurement**: Provides relative velocity of moving obstacles (critical for collision avoidance logic)
- **All-weather immunity**: Operates day/night, under sun glare, no light attenuation
- **Small form factor**: 5-10 cm × 3-5 cm, <100 g
- **Cost-effective**: $200-800 for 77 GHz FMCW module

Disadvantages:

- **Water surface clutter**: Calm water reflects 77 GHz energy specularly, creating false detections
  - Mitigation: Background subtraction, static clutter maps
  - Performance degradation: 50% false-positive rate in smooth water conditions
- **Limited field of view**: 120° azimuth × 25° elevation (vs. 360° camera)
- **Sparse detection**: 100-300 points per frame (vs. 100k from LiDAR)
- **Non-line-of-sight failure**: Cannot detect obstacles hidden behind banks/vegetation

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mmWave + Vision Fusion Performance:

Sensor fusion combining radar sparse detections with camera bounding box regression achieves **86-92% obstacle detection accuracy** (vs. 62-75% vision-only) in challenging scenarios including fog, rain, and backlighting.[10][7-1]

Recommendation: mmWave radar **essential supplement for fog scenarios** (visibility <5 m). Primary obstacle detection should remain acoustic (sonar) for subsurface awareness. **Budget allocation**: $500-1200 for dual-sensor (radar + camera) fusion package if fog operation is mission requirement; otherwise optional.[11][8-1]

PART B: UNDERWATER PERCEPTION (SUBSURFACE)

4. Acoustic Sensors: Single-Beam vs. Forward-Looking vs. Side-Scan Sonar

Sonar Modality Comparison:

Sonar Type	Frequency	Range	Primary Use	River Suitability
Single-Beam Altimeter	200-500 kHz	0.5-100 m	Depth measurement (downward-only)	Poor (no forward obstacle warning)
Forward-Looking Sonar (FLS)	70-120 kHz	75-600 m	3D obstacle imaging, real-time avoidance	**Excellent (primary choice)**
Side-Scan Sonar	100-400 kHz	50-500 m	Seabed mapping, survey (lateral view)	Poor (navigation-incompatible geometry)
Multibeam Echosounder	200-400 kHz	10-300 m	High-resolution bathymetry	Fair (slow, computational overhead)

Forward-Looking Sonar (FLS) Specifications & Performance:

FLS provides **real-time 3D acoustic imaging** with:

- **120° field of view** (horizontal swath)
- **Obstacle avoidance mode**: 75-600 m range, automated alarm thresholds
- **Bathymetry mode**: Color-coded depth imagery, seabed terrain mapping
- **Roll/Pitch stabilization**: ±20° compensation for USV platform motion

River-specific advantages:

- **Turbidity-immune**: Acoustic propagation unaffected by suspended sediment (unlike optical/LiDAR)
- **Vegetation penetration**: Detects obstacles behind dense aquatic plants
- **Subsurface rock detection**: Critical for preventing groundings in uncharted waters
- **Night/poor visibility operation**: Independent of lighting conditions

Performance degradation in muddy rivers:

Muddy bottom reflectivity is **lower than sand/gravel**, reducing return signal strength:

- Acoustic attenuation coefficient k increases with sediment load
- Estimated 2-5 dB/100 m signal loss in highly turbid rivers
- Vegetation clutter: Dense aquatic plants create false echoes (10-20 dB above bottom signal)
- **Maximum effective range in muddy rivers**: 100-200 m (vs. 600 m in clear ocean)

COTS FLS Recommendations (Budget-tiered):

1. **Budget (<$5k)**:
   - **Ping360 (Blue Robotics)**: 750 kHz, ±50 m range, compact (10 cm), open-source control, $4,000-4,500[12]
   - **Tritech Micron**: 330 kHz, $5k-8k, excellent image clarity, research-grade[12-1]
2. **Mid-range ($5k-12k)**:
   - **Blueprint Subsea Mistral FLS**: 120 kHz, $12k-18k, professional maritime, 3D imaging, thermal stabilization
   - **Navico professional suite**: $5k-8k, hobbyist-friendly integration
3. **High-end (>$12k)**:
   - **Tritech Gemini 3D**: Multibeam imaging
   - **ARIES multibeam**: High-frequency bathymetry

When FLS is Essential vs. Optional:

Essential when:

1. River depth variability >2 m over short distances (hidden rocks, logs)
2. Navigation in GPS-denied areas (bridges, overhanging vegetation)
3. Turbidity >50 NTU (optical sensors useless)

4. Speed >1.5 m/s (reaction time requires >50 m detection range)

Optional when:

1. River depth constant <1.5 m with clear bottom visibility
2. Slow speed (<0.5 m/s) with human operator monitoring
3. Well-charted waterways with known obstacles
4. Budget constraint <$8k total sensing

Recommendation: **FLS mandatory for autonomous operation** in uncharted turbid rivers. Budget $4k-5k for Ping360 or equivalent as minimum viable sonar.[12-2]

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5. Optical Underwater Cameras: Viability Assessment in Turbid Rivers

Light Attenuation Fundamentals:

Underwater light intensity decays exponentially following Beer-Lambert law: $I(z) = I_0 e^{-kz}$

Diffuse attenuation coefficient k is **turbidity-dependent:**

Water Condition	Secchi Depth	k Coefficient	Visual Range
Clear (oligotrophic lakes)	4-5 m	0.1-0.15 m^{-1}	10-15 m
Moderately turbid	1-2 m	0.5-1.0 m^{-1}	2-4 m
Highly turbid (muddy rivers)	<0.5 m	1.5-3.0 m^{-1}	<1 m

Color-dependent penetration:

- **Red light (>600 nm)**: Absorbed within 1-2 m (useless for underwater)
- **Green light (500-550 nm)**: Optimal for freshwater; 5-15 m range in clear rivers
- **Blue light (400-500 nm)**: Penetrates ocean 10-20 m; poor in freshwater (organic tannins absorb blue)

Optical Camera Viability by Application:

Scenario	Feasibility	Notes
Clear rivers (Secchi >2m)	✓ Viable	Standard RGB cameras with green filters; $200-600 investment
Shallow monitoring (<1 m)	✓ Viable	Action cameras (GoPro), waterproof housings; $100-300
Daytime-only ops	✓ Viable	Passive sun lighting sufficient
Fish/ecosystem monitoring	✓ Viable	Lower resolution acceptable; <$500 budget
Turbid rivers (>20 NTU)	✗ Not viable	Optical cameras essentially blind (<0.5 m visibility)
Night operations	✗ Not viable	Active illumination creates backscatter, worsens visibility
Autonomous obstacle avoidance	✗ Not viable	Cannot extract reliable depth/obstacle data in turbid water

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Active Illumination Approaches (Research-Grade):

Polarization-based underwater imaging uses **linearly polarized light transmission** to reduce backscatter from suspended particles:

- **Principle**: Transmit linearly polarized light; receive only depolarized returns from objects
- **Backscatter reduction**: 50-70% improvement in turbid conditions
- **Implementation cost**: $5k-15k for research-grade system (not standard COTS)
- **Practical limitation**: Requires synchronized illumination + polarization filter on camera

Recommendation: **Acoustic sonar superior to optical cameras** for turbid river navigation. Underwater optical cameras useful **only as secondary payload** for scientific observation/specimen classification, not for autonomous collision avoidance.[13][14]

PART C: NAVIGATION & STATE ESTIMATION (LOCALIZATION)

6. GNSS/GPS: L1 Standard vs. Dual-Band L1/L5 RTK

Standard L1 GPS Limitations in Rivers:

Multipath Error:
Signals reflect off water surface, riverbanks, vegetation, buildings → **2-5 m error typical** at 1-sigma confidence. Near-vertical banks can create 5-10 m position jumps.

GPS Denial:
Bridge overpasses, dense riparian vegetation cause **complete signal blockage** over 100-500 m distances. Vehicle must rely entirely on dead reckoning (IMU integration) during these blackout periods.

Accuracy: ±5-10 m standard GPS in open conditions; ±10-20 m in river canyons.

Cost: $50-200 for consumer u-blox NEO-M9N module.

Dual-Band L1/L5 RTK GPS Advantages:

Ionospheric Error Correction:
L1 and L5 experience different ionospheric delays proportional to f^{-2}:

- L1 (1.575 GHz): Larger delay magnitude
- L5 (1.176 GHz): Different magnitude due to lower frequency

By measuring **both delays**, dual-band receivers solve for integer ambiguity, eliminating ~90% of ionospheric error (~2.5-5 m in standard L1 RTK).

Multipath Mitigation:

- L5 signal has higher power and narrower bandwidth than L1
- Reduced susceptibility to reflected signals
- Better performance in urban canyons and vegetated waterways

Performance:

- **Accuracy**: 2-5 cm horizontal (RTK-enabled) vs. 5-10 m L1-only
- **Convergence time**: 10-30 seconds to centimeter-level fix (vs. 2-5 minutes L1-only)
- **Reliability**: >95% availability even in marginal signal conditions

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RTK Accuracy Requirements by River Type:

River Width	Obstacle Density	Required Accuracy	Recommended System
<5 m (narrow channels)	High (banks, snags)	±20-30 cm	L1/L5 RTK + sonar + camera
5-20 m (moderate)	Medium	±50-100 cm	L1 RTK or L1/L5 standard
>20 m (wide, open)	Low	±2-5 m	Standard L1 GPS sufficient

Recommendation: **L1/L5 RTK essential for narrow rivers** (<10 m width). Standard L1 GPS acceptable for wide rivers if sonar provides primary obstacle detection.[15][16]

COTS Options (Budget-conscious):

- **u-blox ZED-F9K**: L1/L5, $400-600, multipath rejection, industrial reliability
- **TOPGNSS GN2336-T60**: L1/L5 multi-constellation (GPS/BDS/Galileo/GLONASS), $300-500
- **Emlid Reach M+**: L1/L5 RTK, integrated RTKLIB, $500-700, open-source-friendly[17][18]

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7. IMU: Accelerometer & Gyroscope for Pitch/Roll Compensation

Challenge with Accelerometer-Only Attitude:

Accelerometers measure $\vec{a}_{\text{total}} = \vec{a}_{\text{vehicle}} + \vec{g}$ (gravitational + dynamic acceleration indistinguishable). In dynamic motion (acceleration, braking, turning), this creates **false pitch/roll estimates** of 5-20°.

Solution: Complementary Filter (gyro-dominated fusion):

$$\text{roll}(t) = \alpha(\text{roll}(t-1) + \omega_x \Delta t) + (1-\alpha)\arctan(a_y/a_z)$$

where:

- α = 0.95-0.98 (gyroscope trust weight, high for dynamic stability)
- ω_x = gyroscope angular velocity (deg/s)
- a_y, a_z = accelerometer projections of gravity vector
- Δt = sampling period

Key principle: Gyroscopes (fast, accurate short-term) integrate rotational rate; accelerometers (slow, biased long-term) provide drift correction. Complementary filter achieves:

- Static accuracy: ±0.5-1° (accelerometer reference)
- Dynamic stability: <2° error during active maneuvering

Pitch/Roll Accuracy Requirements for Maritime Cameras:

Camera Type	Acceptable Tilt	Impact of >Tilt
Global shutter (standard)	±30°	Horizon appears straight; acceptable
Rolling shutter (row-sync)	±5°	Horizon curves; geometric distortion increases
Polarization filter (CPL)	±2-3°	Filter misalignment; glare suppression degrades to 30-40%

Recommended IMU Specifications:

- **Gyroscope bias drift**: <5°/hour acceptable (consumer), <0.5°/hour preferred (military-grade)
- **Accelerometer noise**: <50 mg RMS acceptable, <10 mg preferred
- **Roll/pitch accuracy**: ±2° achievable with complementary filter
- **Update rate**: 50 Hz minimum (USB), 200 Hz preferred for dynamic corrections

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Recommended Low-Cost IMU Modules:

Module	Type	Cost	Accuracy	Use Case
MPU-6050	6-DOF (accel+gyro)	$15-25	±5°	Budget camera tilt correction
BNO055	9-DOF (accel+gyro+mag)	$30-50	±1-2°	Integrated Kalman filter onboard
ICM-20948	9-DOF	$20-40	±2°	Low-power, high sensitivity
WitMotion WT-931	9-DOF + barometer	$50-80	±1-2°	CAN interface, robust for boats[19][20]
Xsens MTi-430 AHRS	9-DOF AHRS	$600-900	±0.5°	Professional, integrated sensor fusion

Recommendation for university project: **BNO055 or WitMotion WT-931** (~$40-80). BNO055 has onboard Kalman filter; WT-931 has CAN interface for maritime autopilot integration.

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8. Magnetometer: Compass & Hard/Soft Iron Distortions on Boats

Magnetic Interference Sources on Fiberglass USV:

Hard Iron Distortion (permanent magnetic bias):

- Ferromagnetic materials: Steel hull reinforcements, DC motors, LiPo batteries, wiring
- Creates constant offset vector **V_HI** = [V_x, V_y, V_z]
- Typical magnitude on fiberglass boat: 20-50 μT (Earth's field ~48 μT)
- **Heading error**: ±10-20° systematic (consistent bias in one direction)

Soft Iron Distortion (induced magnetic field warping):

- Ferrous materials become magnetized by Earth's field, creating induced distortion matrix **W_SI**
- Stretches/rotates measurement ellipsoid along principal axes
- Typical magnitude: 10-30% ellipsoid elongation
- **Heading error**: ±20-40° (direction-dependent; worse when bow points toward magnetic sources)

Impact without calibration: Combined hard+soft iron causes ±20-40° heading error, making compass-based navigation unsafe for autonomous operation.[21][22]

Calibration Procedures:

2D Calibration (Yaw-only, faster):

1. Rotate vessel 360° in horizontal plane (use spirit level for leveling)
2. Collect 200-400 magnetometer samples during rotation
3. Fit ellipse to [m_x, m_y] 2D data projection
4. Solve for hard iron offsets [b_x, b_y] and soft iron 2×2 matrix

Duration: 5-10 minutes
Effectiveness: Reduces error from ±30° → ±5-10°

3D Calibration (Full attitude compensation, thorough):

1. Rotate vessel in all three axes (pitch, roll, yaw) for 10-15 minutes
2. Collect 500-1000 samples covering all orientations
3. Fit 3D ellipsoid to full magnetometer data
4. Solve 10-parameter model: [3 hard iron + 6 soft iron matrix + 1 field strength]

Effectiveness: Reduces error from ±30° → ±0.5-2° heading accuracy

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Practical Mitigation Strategies:

1. **Sensor Placement**: Mount magnetometer **1.5-2 m away from batteries, motors, metal hull**
   - Ideal: Mast top, away from ferrous objects
   - Minimum acceptable: 0.5 m separation + mu-metal shielding
2. **Mu-Metal Shielding**: Wrap ferrous objects (motor mounts, battery boxes) with mu-metal (μ = 80-120)
   - Cost: $5-15 per sheet
   - Effectiveness: 10-30 dB attenuation of nearby fields
3. **Recalibration Cycle**: Re-calibrate whenever new payloads/batteries added
   - Takes 5-10 minutes (2D) or 15-20 minutes (3D)
   - Critical for safety-critical operations
4. **Sensor Fusion Strategy**: Use dual-redundancy
   - **Primary**: IMU gyroscope + accelerometer for heading (no magnetometer)
   - **Secondary**: Magnetometer-fused AHRS (complementary filter) for long-term drift correction
   - **Blending**: 95% IMU + 5% magnetometer corrections

Recommendation: Magnetometer **helpful but not essential** if high-quality IMU (gyro drift <1°/min) is integrated. Can skip magnetometer entirely if GNSS+visual odometry provides adequate heading reference.[22-1][23]

PART D: RESEARCH-GRADE BUDGET SENSOR SUITE & INTEGRATION

Recommended Bill of Materials (University Project Budget: $5k-8k)

Component	Model	Cost	Function	Rationale
Primary Camera	OAK-D Lite	$400-600	Visual obstacle detection, stereo depth	Global shutter capable, integrated IMU, USB-powered, ROS-compatible
Backup Optical Camera	Basler dart BCON	$300-400	HD video, polarization filter support	Industrial-grade, -20 to +70°C, GigE interface
LiDAR	Livox Mid-360	$400-600	3D point cloud, above-water obstacles	Solid-state, compact, 50-100 m range, EMI-resistant
Forward-Looking Sonar	Ping360 (Blue Robotics)	$4,000-4,500	Underwater obstacle, bathymetry	750 kHz, ±50 m range, open-source control, ROS integration[12-3]
mmWave Radar	TI IWR1843 BOOST	$200-300	Non-optical detection (fog/glare)	77 GHz FMCW, optional if budget tight
RTK GNSS	TOPGNSS GN2336-T60	$300-500	Centimeter-level positioning	L1/L5, multi-constellation, $300-500
Primary IMU	WitMotion WT-931	$60-80	Pitch/roll/yaw, camera compensation	9-DOF, CAN bus, waterproof housing
Magnetometer	Honeywell HMC5883L	$10-20	Heading reference	I2C interface, optional if skipping
Power Module	Pixhawk PM07	$40-50	Voltage/current monitoring	Voltage/current rail, <500 mA quiescent
Main Computer	Raspberry Pi 4 (8GB)	$120-150	Sensor fusion, navigation, telemetry	ROS-compatible, sufficient for real-time processing
AI Accelerator	Jetson Orin Nano	$80-120	Deep learning inference (obstacle classification)	40 TOPS, 25W TDP, CUDA-accelerated

Component	Model	Cost	Function	Rationale
Radio Telemetry	RFD900x + antenna	$250-350	Command/telemetry (30+ km range)	Budget alternative: LoRa+ESP32 ($50-100)
Waterproof Enclosures	Pelican cases + gaskets	$150-200	Electronics protection	5+ reusable components
Subsea Connectors	ODI/BlueRobotics bulkheads	$150-200	Waterproof integration	Cost driver; careful sourcing essential
Mechanical	Aluminum mounts, vibration isolators	$100-150	Sensor integration	Aluminum profiles, silicone dampers

Total Cost (Recommended Config): **~$6,500-7,500**

Cost Reductions if Budget Tight:

- Skip mmWave radar: -$300
- Use single optical camera (skip backup): -$300-400
- Skip Jetson Nano (use Pi 4 only): -$100
- Use cheaper sonar (non-FLS): -$2,000-3,000 (but reduced capability)

Optimal Mounting Positions & EMI Mitigation

Above-Water Sensor Mounting:

1. **OAK-D Lite Camera**
   - **Position**: Bow centerline, 0.5-1 m above waterline
   - **Orientation**: Forward-facing, 0-5° downward tilt (for water boundary)
   - **EMI Isolation**: 1 m from motor ESC, 0.5 m from magnetometer
   - **Rationale**: Minimize parallax with sonar; avoid mast wind deflection
2. **Livox Mid-360 LiDAR**
   - **Position**: Bow pole, 1.2-1.5 m height (above water splashes)
   - **Orientation**: Horizontal scan plane (sideways obstacle view)
   - **Rationale**: Avoid water specular reflections; detect riverbank obstacles
   - **EMI Isolation**: 0.3 m from antennas, away from high-current wiring
3. **GNSS/RTK Antenna**

- **Position**: Mast top, minimum 1.5 m above water
- **Clearance**: 2 m radius free of metallic objects
- **Rationale**: Maximize satellite visibility; minimize multipath reflections

4. **Magnetometer (HMC5883L/BNO055)**
   - **Position**: Bow pole, 2-3 m from motor/battery (ferrous sources)
   - **Protection**: Mu-metal enclosure recommended
   - **Rationale**: Farthest from hard iron interference sources
5. **Primary IMU (WitMotion WT-931)**
   - **Position**: Vessel centerline at COG (center of gravity)
   - **Mounting**: Silicone vibration isolators (<5 Hz natural frequency)
   - **Rationale**: Accurate roll/pitch/yaw; vibration damping reduces gyro noise

Underwater Sensor Mounting:

6. **Ping360 Forward-Looking Sonar**
   - **Position**: Bow thruster tube or dedicated penetrator
   - **Depth**: 0.3-0.5 m below waterline (avoids wave splashing)
   - **Orientation**: 0° (dead ahead) + 360° scanning
   - **Rationale**: Reduces multipath from surface waves

EMI Mitigation Strategy:

Source	Mitigation Method	Implementation
Motor ESC	1.0 m separation + Faraday cage	Enclosure around ESC + ferrite clamps on power wires (5-10 clamps)
High-current wiring	Twisted pair cables, shielded conduit	Star-point grounding; avoid ground loops
GNSS antenna cable	Physical separation from ESC	Run along opposite boat rails (>0.5 m apart)
Sonar transmit cable	Ferrite clamp filtering	3-5 clamps at 5 cm spacing
Magnetometer	Shielded twisted pair (STP)	Ground shield at single point only (not both ends)
Radio antenna	1.5 m separation from compass	Orthogonal polarization if possible

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Power Budget & Battery Sizing

Component	Typical Power	Peak Power	Duty Cycle	Average
OAK-D Lite	2.0 W	2.5 W	100%	2.0 W
Basler camera	4.0 W	4.5 W	30%	1.2 W
Livox LiDAR	4.5 W	5.0 W	100%	4.5 W
Ping360 sonar	8.0 W	15 W (pulse)	50% (duty-cycled)	8.0 W
TI IWR1843 radar	1.2 W	1.5 W	50%	0.6 W
WT-931 IMU	0.3 W	0.5 W	100%	0.3 W
GNSS receiver	0.5 W	0.8 W	100%	0.5 W
Raspberry Pi 4	5.0 W	8.0 W	80%	4.0 W
Jetson Orin Nano	6.0 W	20 W (inference)	50%	10.0 W
Motor + ESC	50 W	150 W	30% (propulsion)	15 W
Total sustained	—	—	—	**~46 W**

Battery Sizing for 8-hour endurance: 400 Wh LiPo required
Typical (6S 10000 mAh): ~223 Wh usable → **4.5-hour endurance** (accounting for voltage sag from 12V → 10.5V cutoff)

Integration Architecture & Recommended Configuration

Optimal System Stack:

1. **Primary perception**: OAK-D Lite (RGB-D stereo) + Ping360 sonar
2. **Auxiliary redundancy**: Livox Mid-360 LiDAR (above-water), optional mmWave radar
3. **Navigation**: L1/L5 RTK GPS + 9-DOF IMU (WitMotion WT-931)
4. **Radio link**: RFD900x (if >5 km required) or LoRa+ESP32 (budget alternative)
5. **Processing**: Raspberry Pi 4 (8GB) + Jetson Orin Nano for AI inference

Critical Design Decisions:

- **Global shutter mandatory** (not rolling shutter) for collision avoidance
- **Sonar essential** for turbid water—optical insufficient alone
- **L1/L5 RTK GPS necessary** for narrow rivers (<10 m width)
- **Sensor fusion** (vision+IMU+sonar+radar) beats single modality
- **EMI control crucial**—proper shielding/grounding prevents weeks of debugging

Development Timeline:

- Hardware procurement: 2-3 weeks
- Mechanical integration: 3-4 weeks
- Sensor calibration: 1-2 weeks
- Software integration & testing: 4-6 weeks
- **Total**: 10-15 weeks for functional prototype

This comprehensive survey provides the technical foundation for designing robust, redundant sensor stacks optimized for autonomous river navigation in challenging, turbid environments where single-modality perception is insufficient for safe operation.

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